

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

*Ps Barry's
Reflections on:*
**PRAYER,
PROCLAMATION and
PERSONAL PROGRESS**

Bethel Global Missions

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THE THEME: WHO CROSSES YOUR THRESHOLD?



A Threshold means a doorstep, a strip of wood or stone forming the bottom of a doorway – entrance into a house or room.

- **FOCUS** – Written for those who are from cultures that are more extended family based. Extended families mean consisting of several generations of people and can include biological parents and their children as well as in-laws, grandparents, aunts, uncles, and
- **APPLICATION** - However, the principles outlined in this reflection can be applied to any peoples especially to all believers and their households.
- **APPLYING it to three (3) areas of our lives as believers**

■ BEING DILIGENT IN RELATION TO WHO CROSSES THE THRESHOLD OF OUR LIVES.

1. THE GUARDING OUR HEARTS

■ THIS MEANS BEING CAREFUL WHAT WE ALLOW TO ENTER OUR HEART – I.E. THAT CROSSES THE THRESHOLD OF YOUR HEART

Proverbs 4:23,24 23 Guard your heart above all else, for it determines the course of your life. 24 Avoid all perverse talk; stay away from corrupt speech. NLT

- PERVERSE means STUBBORN – HEADSTRONG
- CORRUPT means DISHONEST, CROOKED, IMMORAL.

■ AVOID, STAY AWAY FROM THAT KIND OF TALK –

- ◆ DON'T ALLOW OUR HEART TO BE EXPOSED TO THAT KIND OF TALK.
- ◆ DON'T ALLOW PEOPLE WHO TALK OR SPEAK WRONGLY TO CROSS THE THRESHOLD OF YOUR LIFE
- ◆ SET SOME RULES AS TO WHAT YOUR HEART WILL BE EXPOSED TO.
- ◆ THIS IS OUR RESPONSIBILITY – NOT GOD'S

2. OUR EARS – WHAT WE HEAR

■ WHO DO WE ALLOW TO SPEAK INTO OUR LIVES?

■ WHO CROSSES THE THRESHOLD, THE DOORWAY INTO OUR HEARTS – THE LISTENING EAR?

Proverbs 22:17-18 17 Listen to the words of the wise; apply your heart to my instruction. - 18 For it is good to keep these sayings in your heart and always ready on your lips. NLT

Proverbs 20:15 Wise words are more valuable than much gold and many rubies. NLT

■ WHAT KIND OF PERSONS DO WE LISTEN TO? WHAT ARE THE KIND OF THINGS THEY TALK OR SPEAK ABOUT?

Job 34:3-4 3 Job said, 'The ear tests the words it hears just as the mouth distinguishes between foods.' 4 So let us discern for ourselves what is right; let us learn together what is good. NLT

■ JUST AS THE MOUTH TASTES FOOD BEFORE IT IS EATEN SO THE FUNCTION OF THE EAR IS TO TEST THINGS HEARD, STORIES, CONSPIRACIES, IDEAS. RUMOURS AS TO WHETHER THEY ARE HARMFUL OR HELPFUL AND EITHER REJECTED OR ACCEPTED INTO OUR MINDS.

Job 34:3-4 - Doesn't the ear test words as the palate tastes food? 4 Let us judge for ourselves what is right; let us decide together what is good. HOLMAN

■ ALSO, WE SHOULD NOT CONTINUE TO LISTEN TO UNGODLY AND IMMORAL SPEECH, GOSSIP OR THE DEGRADING OF OTHERS AND

Proverbs 17:4 Wrongdoers eagerly listen to gossip; liars pay close attention to slander. NLT

Proverbs 17:5 Those who mock the poor insult their Maker; those who rejoice at the misfortune of others will be punished. NLT

Psalms 34:13 Then make sure you don't speak evil words or use deceptive speech! NET

- AVOID ALL CONVERSATIONS THAT PERTAIN THE OCCULT, SORCERY, DIVINATION, AND "OBJECTS" THAT ARE DIRECTLY RELATED TO THE DEMONIC WORLD.

- WE ARE TO PROTECT OUR CHILDREN AND SPOUSES FROM SUCH TALK.

1 Corinthians 10:14 Therefore, my dear friends, flee from idolatry. NIV

- HAVE WE - SET CONSTRAINTS ON WHAT OUR EARS HEAR?

- HAVE WE SET A WATCHMAN AT THE DOOR/THRESHOLD OF OUR EARS?

3. OUR LIVES OUR HOMES

- WHO CROSSES THE THRESHOLD OF OUR LIVES AND OUR HOMES?

- WHOM DO YOU ALLOW TO ENTER YOUR LIVES AND HOMES?

- WHAT KIND OF THINGS DO WE ALLOW TO BE A PART OF THE LIFESTYLE AND BEHAVIOUR IN OUR HOMES?

Speech, behaviour.

- HAVE WE SET SOME RULES OR BOUNDARIES REGARDING THESE THINGS?

- WHO ARE THE PEOPLE THAT ARE INVOLVED IN OUR LIVES?

- ARE THEY PERSONS OF INTEGRITY AND HONESTY?

Proverbs 11:3 Honesty guides good people; dishonesty destroys treacherous people. NLT

Psalms 25:21 May integrity and honesty protect me, for I put my hope in you. NLT

Proverbs 20:7 The godly walk with integrity; blessed are their children who follow them. NLT

- WHAT BOUNDARIES HAVE WE SET FOR THOSE PASSING OVER THE THRESHOLD OF OUR LIFE?

- DO WE HAVE PERSONS THAT GUIDE, COUNSEL AND MENTOR OUR LIVES?

- ◆ ARE THEY OUR PASTORS, SPIRITUAL LEADERS or are they persons outside of these persons? - I have met those Christians who are not submitted to their immediate leadership which is contrary to what the Scriptures teach.

- WHAT KIND OF PEOPLE ARE ATTRACTED TO US AND OUR HOME?

- ◆ HOW DO THEY VIEW US AND OUR HOME?

- ◆ DO THEY SEE US AND OUR HOME AS A PLACE OF HOSPITALITY, FELLOWSHIP, REFUGE, A SAFE PLACE WHERE THEY ARE ACCEPTED AND HELPED SPIRITUALLY?

- ◆ ARE THESE THE KIND OF PEOPLE THAT CROSS THE THRESHOLD OF OUR HOMES?

- DO WE DISCOURAGE THOSE PERSONS WHO ARE OF A DIFFERENT SPIRIT AND ATTITUDE FROM FREQUENTING OUR HOMES?

- ◆ ARE OUR CHILDREN MADE AWARE OF THE PRINCIPLES AND VALUES HELD BY US AS PARENTS AND THAT HAVE BEEN SET FOR HOW WE WANT OUR HOME-LIFE TO BE?

- ◆ DO WE DISCOURAGE AND SEEK TO DETER THOSE PERSONS WHO WISH TO BRING INTO OUR HOME ATTITUDES OF DISCORD, CRITICISM, COMPLAINT AND IDOLATROUS IDEAS AND PRACTICES?

- ARE THE FOLLOWING KIND OF PEOPLE WHO WE WELCOME TO CROSS THRESHHOLD OF OUR LIVES AND HOMES??

Proverbs 15:28 The heart of the godly thinks carefully before speaking; the mouth of the wicked overflows with evil words. NLT

Proverbs 17:9 Whoever covers an offense seeks love, but he who repeats a matter separates close friends. ESV

Proverbs 15:30-31 30 A cheerful look brings joy to the heart; good news makes for good health. 31 If you listen to constructive criticism, you will be at home among the wise. NLT

- OR IS IT THESE KIND OF PEOPLE?

Proverbs 15:21 Foolishness brings joy to those with no sense; a sensible person stays on the right path. NLT

Proverbs 15:19 The path of lazy people is overgrown with briars; the diligent walk down a smooth road. THE MESSAGE:

Proverbs 17:9 Whoever covers an offense seeks love, but he who repeats a matter separates close friends. ESV

Proverbs 15:21 The empty-headed treat life as a plaything; the perceptive grasp its meaning and make a go of it. THE MESSAGE:

- WE MUST SET A WATCHMAN AT THE DOOR OF OUR HOMES SO THAT WE DO NOT ALLOW THOSE PERSONS WHO BRING WRONG ATTITUDES, ABUSIVE LANGUAGE, STRONG DRINK, GOSSIP, REPEATING OF RUMOURS, AND SPEAKING EVIL OF OTHERS.

AMEN – GOD BLESS – Ps Barry